

Deliverable 4: Social Awareness & Cultural Competence

Building Inclusive Team Environments & Developing Cultural Competence

70% Journey Milestone Completed

Congratulations on completing the fourth step of your journey! 70% through! Great progress..... But before we go ahead, let's reflect upon what you learned during this module regarding social awareness, understanding others' perspectives, respect, and developing cultural competence.

Assignment Prompt

Imagine you are working on a team project with colleagues from different cultural backgrounds. Go over each required step: self-reflection on your cultural background, analyzing team differences, practicing active listening, embracing diversity, reflecting on interactions, and developing cultural competence for a different culture (e.g., someone you work with or interact with daily). Submit a 3-minute recording explaining your response.

1. Reflection on Own Cultural Background

Shaping Perspectives and Values

Growing up immersed in rich Indian traditions, my perspective and values have been strongly shaped by collectivism, respect for elders, community harmony, and collaborative problem-solving. This cultural background influences my communication style to be relationship-oriented and polite, often prioritizing group consensus and maintaining interpersonal harmony during discussions.

2. Analyzing Team Cultural Differences

Recognizing Diverse Perspectives

Working in a diverse cross-cultural team means interacting with colleagues who may come from individualistic cultures that value directness, autonomy, and rapid task-oriented feedback. Recognizing these differences prevents misunderstandings, ensuring I interpret direct communication styles as professional clarity rather than abruptness.

3. Active Listening & Clarifying Viewpoints

Avoiding Assumptions

To ensure an inclusive environment, I practice active listening by letting team members fully articulate their ideas without interruption. I ask open-ended clarifying questions and repeat back core concepts to confirm understanding, consciously avoiding hasty assumptions or cultural stereotyping.

4. Embracing Diversity & Continuous Learning

Leveraging Innovation Through Diversity

Diversity serves as a powerful catalyst for creativity and innovation. By remaining open to learning from my peers' unique professional and cultural experiences, we blend analytical frameworks with creative perspectives to arrive at superior project solutions.

5. Developing Cultural Competence (Case Focus)

Deepening Competence in a Different Cultural Context

Focusing on a daily professional interaction with a colleague from a Western, low-context communication culture, my step-by-step approach to building cultural competence involves: (1) researching cultural communication norms regarding feedback and meetings; (2) observing non-verbal cues and working preferences; (3) adapting my communication style to be more concise and direct when required; and (4) openly discussing working styles to build mutual trust.

6. Interaction Reflection & Future Adaptation

Managing Challenges and Future Growth

Reflecting on initial coordination challenges—such as balancing indirect politeness with direct task execution—taught me the importance of situational adaptability. In future projects, I will proactively establish team norms that accommodate both relational harmony and direct productivity.

Submission Checklist for 3-Minute Video

- ☐ Structure your 3-minute recording to cover all 6 cultural competence steps above.
- ☐ Record the video presentation clearly outlining your personal reflection and action plan.
- ☐ Submit your recording file before the module deadline.